



NVIDIA cut video call bandwidth

NVIDIA Research has found a way to use AI to reduce video call bandwidth while improving quality. <http://digit.in/nov20-07>



Facebook will ban QAnon

Facebook will ban any pages, groups, and accounts representing the conspiracy theory QAnon. <http://digit.in/nov20-08>

have been recycled and reused to manufacture new electronic devices. Also, undocumented domestic and commercial e-waste is usually mixed with other waste streams (plastic and metal) and even if they are recycled along with these streams, it is usually done under inferior conditions, without depollution measures or the recovery of valuable materials. As per the Global E-waste Monitor 2020, the value for raw materials in the global e-waste generated in 2019 is equal to approximately \$57 billion. A large portion of this e-waste could have been recovered, thereby reducing the need to use virgin materials.

Instead, as more people continue buying electronic equipment, manufacturers have begun facing a dire shortage of raw materials needed to make these products, so reclaiming and recycling e-waste material doesn't just make environmental sense but also economical sense. The Indian Government first introduced its dedicated e-waste management policy in 2011 and expanded its scope in 2016, still, less than 5 percent of e-waste in India was recycled through regulated units, as per an article by Australia India Institute. Since 2014, numerous countries across the globe have adopted a national e-waste policy (78 countries as of 2019), however, regulatory advances of e-waste in some regions of the world are slow and the enforcement is weak

as well, which is stunting e-waste management in many parts of the world.

THE NEED FOR A CIRCULAR ECONOMY

There's an undeniable need for change. Countries across the globe need to work towards setting up a circular economy which will change the tides from the 'take, make, and dispose' process to a more sustainable one that includes recovery and recycling of e-waste to reutilise the materials in production. For this to happen, the formal recycling and informal collection sectors must be brought together to form a more effective framework. To facilitate this dialogue, the WEEE Forum hosted the third International E-Waste Day virtually on October 14. India joined over 40 other countries on October 14 in a virtual conference to raise awareness on the issue of e-waste and discuss the merits of implementing a circular economy. Karo Sambhav, an Indian Producer Responsibility Organisation (PRO), was the first and only PRO to join the WEEE Forum from Asia. They hosted the third international e-waste day conference in association with the US-India Business Council (USIBC) titled 'A circular economy in E-waste for an Atmanirbhar Bharat (self-reliant India)'.

At the event, Pranshu Singhal, Founder, Karo Sambhav said, "Since

the very beginning our focus has been on mainstreaming of this issue and at this forum we deliberated on solutions for developing a responsible and sustainable ewaste management ecosystem that moves the sector forward. The Covid-19 crisis has forced us to identify and adapt to a different way of life. We now need to chart our course for the 'Decade of Action' and commit ourselves to build a truly circular economy in India." The conference also had keynote speakers such as Mr Ashok Kheterpal, Chairman, Haryana Pollution Control Board, and Dr Ashok Kumar Ghosh, Chairman, Bihar Pollution Control Board. They further emphasised the importance of collaboration between manufacturers and government bodies to properly manage e-waste, and the importance of compliance to the regulatory frameworks. Mr Pascal Leroy, Director General of WEEE Forum said, "The practice of purchasing and processing metal scrap that contains e-waste must be banned unless the facilities that treat and recycle it are officially permitted or certified."

The issue still remains that non-compliant or informal collection of e-waste is exceedingly prevalent since it proves to be the cheaper option over regulation complaint recycling. The public awareness of e-waste hazards and proper disposal methods is also low in India. The drive towards creating a circular economy in India must be facilitated by increase awareness about the issue, upskilling informal sector players to recycle e-waste efficiently, and deploying mature recycling technologies in the informal sector while developing innovative new solutions for processing new forms of e-waste. Closer to home, you as a consumer can make a difference by not mixing e-waste with other kinds of garbage and ensuring that the waste lands up at a regulation complaint e-waste recycler. So, if you're handing your e-waste over to a kadabiwala, ensure that he knows the appropriate place to get it responsibly recycled. 📺



A paltry 17.4 per cent of e-waste is collected and recycled under appropriate conditions